

Real Estate DPDPA Starter Checklist

Your real estate firm doesn't just close deals — it moves buyer, tenant and property data across people and networks. Work through these ten areas to bring KYC collection, document handling, broker sharing, CRM access and old-lead retention under DPDPA-ready control.

Buyer Leads

Tenant KYC

PAN / Aadhaar

Agreements

Property Papers

WhatsApp Sharing

Broker Networks

Loan Partners

CRM Access

Old Leads

How to use this: tick what you already do, and turn the unticked boxes into your next actions. Start with KYC handling, broker sharing and CRM access — they remove the most risk for the least effort.

1 Buyer / tenant / seller data inventory

- ☐ List where buyer, tenant, seller and landlord data is collected — calls, WhatsApp, site visits, lead forms, referrals.
- ☐ Record what each lead holds, why, and who can access it.
- ☐ Collect only the data the deal actually needs.
- ☐ Keep one primary lead/CRM record so you always know what you hold.
- ☐ Explain data use and sharing in your lead or site-visit form.

2 PAN / Aadhaar / passport KYC

- ☐ Collect PAN, Aadhaar and passport copies only when the deal needs them.
- ☐ Prefer a secure upload link or portal over WhatsApp and email.
- ☐ Mask or limit ID numbers where the full value isn't needed.
- ☐ Don't keep duplicate ID copies on staff phones or personal accounts.
- ☐ Delete ID copies once the deal closes or the purpose ends.

3 Rent agreement & sale deed handling

- ☐ Store agreements, deeds and title papers in access-controlled systems, not open folders.
- ☐ Restrict who can open and forward property documents.
- ☐ Avoid keeping duplicate copies across email, WhatsApp and devices.
- ☐ Track which documents were shared with whom for registration or filing.
- ☐ Apply a retention rule to closed-deal documents.

4 WhatsApp document sharing

- ☐ Reduce PAN, Aadhaar and agreement exchange over WhatsApp.
- ☐ Verify the recipient's number before sending any document.
- ☐ Don't forward KYC or property papers into broker groups.
- ☐ Clear documents from chats once moved into your CRM/records.
- ☐ Use business channels, not staff personal accounts, for client documents.

5 Broker-network & co-broker sharing

- ☐ Share buyer/tenant details only with client instruction or a documented purpose.
- ☐ Avoid circulating leads in open co-broker WhatsApp groups.
- ☐ Don't share lead sheets containing contacts and KYC broadly.
- ☐ Tell clients their details may be shared with co-brokers and partners.
- ☐ Keep a record of what was shared, with whom, and why.

6 Builder / society / landlord sharing

- ☐ Share the minimum buyer/tenant detail needed with builders, societies and landlords.
- ☐ Confirm what each party stores and for how long.
- ☐ Avoid forwarding full KYC where only contact details are needed.
- ☐ Brief field staff on what can and can't be shared.
- ☐ Record onward sharing so you can answer client questions later.

7 Loan partner & bank document sharing

- ☐ Share income, bank and loan documents with lenders only with client awareness/consent.
- ☐ Keep lender sharing purposeful and access-controlled.
- ☐ Avoid forwarding financial documents case-by-case over WhatsApp/email.
- ☐ Confirm what loan agents/NBFCs store and for how long.
- ☐ Record what financial data was shared, with whom, and why.

8 CRM / Google Sheets / staff phone access

- ☐ Consolidate leads and KYC into a CRM/system with role-based access.
- ☐ Limit Google Sheets/Excel lead lists and who can open them.
- ☐ Turn on MFA on email, cloud and CRM accounts.
- ☐ Remove ex-staff and old broker access the same day they leave.
- ☐ Review who can access leads and documents at least twice a year.

9 Old lead & closed-deal retention

- ☐ Set a retention period for old leads, KYC copies, agreements and property papers.
- ☐ Don't keep old buyer/tenant databases indefinitely for 'future deals'.
- ☐ Schedule a periodic review to archive or delete records past their period.
- ☐ Offer clients a way to request deletion or correction of old data.
- ☐ Write retention rules down so the whole team applies them consistently.

10 Wrong-recipient & breach response

- ☐ Write a one-page plan: who to call and what to do first if a document reaches the wrong person.
- ☐ Know how to quickly lock a compromised WhatsApp, email or CRM account.
- ☐ Keep a contact list (IT, software vendor, and a way to reach affected clients).
- ☐ Be ready to notify the Data Protection Board and affected clients as required.
- ☐ After any incident, record what happened and what you changed.